

PPG Meeting
31/07/2025 – Start Time 13:13

Attendees:

MN – Deputy Manager
SA – Practice Manager

MC, GM,
JB, BB, ZF, JS, SN, AW

Apologies:

CC, AK, LU, MAS, DR

- Review of last minutes of meeting – everyone agreed no changes were needed.
- Meeting started at 13:13
- Asked PPG members if they would like anything to be added on Agenda to discuss in todays meeting.
- Discussed 2025 national survey report for the Practice. Gave each patient a coloured copy of the report to review. Once they had reviewed results, they were then given a coloured copy of last years report to compare the scores.
- The report was explained by Practice Manager. This is a national survey sent out yearly to randomly selected patients each year and returned to the provider. The results are of those who have returned the survey. Once they compile the results along with all the other practices, they then publish the national data online and notify the Practices of their results.
- PM went through each question and compared the data with the PPG members. On each question asked the Practice improved the percentage compared to last year.
- PPG members were asked what the Practice could do to get more patients to engage with completing such surveys.
- When checking data online you can also check neighbouring practices, and we compared ours to our PCN practice and we could see a higher percentage of returned surveys for other practices.
- SN suggested we send out text messages when we know surveys will be sent out and if patients struggle to complete, we could ask them to bring into the Surgery to help.
- MN explained that as we are not the ones sending out the surveys, we wouldn't know which patients the survey gets sent too and this would mean we would have to send a text msg to all 6000 patients registered at the Practice.

- MN also highlighted that we do not want any influence on the answers provided and we would like honest feedback from the patients. The patients if they do come in for help may feel obliged to give better scoring than how they actually feel.
- Overall, we are satisfied the outcome of the survey results – we will try and educate the patients who attend the surgery and encourage them to complete such forms/surveys in the future.
- Also decided to display notices before they get sent out.
- Updated the members about not being able to prescribe Mounjaro and this needs to be done through weight management.
- BB asked when they will be able to book in for flu jab. MN explained Flu Season starts from October. MN also explained that the local pharmacies received the vaccines around 2-3 weeks before GP practices if they wish to have it sooner they can find out from their local chemist.
- The Practice has not yet received a confirmation date of delivery for flu jabs.
- Updates around the PCN clinics were shared.
- Meeting was kept brief due to summer holidays and many apologies.

Meeting adjourned 13:51

Next meeting: October 2025

Viking Community Fund—Guidance for Businesses applying for Apprenticeship Funding



Sustaining & developing Shetland communities

Before you begin

All sections of the application must be completed, and you must send the other documents we require for due diligence. To give your application the best chance of success, please be concise in your answers to ensure the key information is captured. A full list of questions for the application are attached as an appendix to these guidelines.

Key information

Who can I contact if I have any questions or need guidance completing the application?

Eleanor Gear
Fund Manager
07538417175
Eleanor.gear@scbf.org.uk

How much funding is available?

The Apprenticeship fund has an annual funding pot of £75,000

How much can I apply for?	The maximum amount of financial support to any business over the three years is currently £5,000 – £15,000. The payments will be made in instalments, on completion of a six-monthly monitoring report and a visit by the fund co-ordinator.				
Where does this money come from?	The Apprenticeship Scheme is financed from the Viking Community Fund.				
How are decisions made?	SCBF will review the eligibility of your application and prepare an appraisal document for a panel of SCBF directors who will make awards based on budget availability.				
When are decisions made?	<table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>Deadline</th><th>Panel meets</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>31st May</td><td>End of July</td></tr> </tbody> </table> We'll contact you within two weeks of the panel meeting date to let you know whether your application has been successful or not.	Deadline	Panel meets	31 st May	End of July
Deadline	Panel meets				
31 st May	End of July				
What can grants be used for?	Financial support will be available for costs involved in employing the apprentice, such as a contribution towards the apprentice's wages, travel and accommodation, specialist workwear, etc. The final amount awarded will vary depending on the context and needs of each business and apprenticeship opportunity. Support from the Viking Community Fund will be additional to that provided by any industry governing bodies such as SECTT, SNIPEF and CITB. These grants need to be declared in the application form, as part of the budget for the apprenticeship position.				
Who can apply?	The scheme will be open to any small private business or social enterprise based in the community benefit area that has less than 15 employees. The apprentice to be employed can be up to the age of 25. You will also be required to: • Demonstrate appropriate health and safety procedures • Ensure adequate equipment to cover the range of training required • Provide proof of relevant employee and public liability insurances • Register the apprentice with the appropriate skills body (if relevant) SCBF are particularly interested if the apprenticeship helps a young person stay in, or move into, the area. The panel is also keen to support apprenticeships where the employment will assist in				

improving local skills shortages.

Guidance on completing the application form

General guidelines

- Please complete all relevant sections. Incomplete applications will be returned.
- In order to give your application the best chance of success, please provide as much information as possible for each section.
- Please don't write 'see attached' on any part of the form as a substitute for information – although if you wish to include other documents (besides those requested at the end of the application) with which to support and supplement your application then you are welcome to do so.
- Please round figures up to the nearest pound.
- Link to website detailing range of apprenticeship frameworks [Search apprenticeship types | Apprenticeships.scot](#) (includes a section on training providers and support)

What happens next?

SCBF staff will check the eligibility of your application and prepare an appraisal document for the panel who will decide upon your application. A decision should be made and advised within 2 weeks of the panel meeting date. Any delays will be advised as soon as possible.

Appendix 1—Application questions

Business Support for Apprenticeship—Application Questions

Section 1 Contact Details

- Contact name:
 - This should be the person we address any correspondence with regarding the application, such as requests for further information or any grant offer.
- Name of Business:
 - This should be the registered name of your business or organisation and that appears on your bank account statement.
- Position in organisation
 - Manager, Secretary, Chairperson etc.
- Telephone number—daytime and alternative:
 - The number of the main contact named on the application.
- Contact email:
 - This will be the email address we will use to send any correspondence regarding the application.
- Correspondence address with postcode

Section 2 Business and Finance Information

- Your registered company number
- Accounting information
 - Total turnover last accounting year
 - Total profit/loss last accounting year
- Other financial information
 - Value and nature of assets associated with the business

	○ Value and source of any loans associated with the business ○ Other sources of funding associated with the business
Section 3 Apprentice Position	● The type of apprenticeship to be followed ○ Modern apprenticeship, graduate apprenticeship ● Proposed start/finish date ● How will you ensure the apprentice receives support and mentoring in the role ○ Do you have a dedicated employee to mentor them? Will you be directly supporting them yourself? ● Do you already have a suitable candidate you are keen to appoint, if yes, complete section 4
Section 4 Candidate details	This section is only for completion if an apprentice has already been selected ● Name of apprentice ● Age at date of application ● Address ● Qualifications to be studied ● How were they identified/recruited ● Apprentice voice ○ A statement from the apprentice on how they feel undertaking this apprenticeship, i.e. why do they want to do it? Has it opened up an opportunity to them not previously available? Is it allowing them to remain in their local area?
Section 5 Impact of apprenticeship	● Impact of the apprenticeship to your business, the apprentice and the wider community ○ How will offering the apprenticeship opportunity help your business now and in the future? Will it improve a skills gap? What will the young person gain from the apprenticeship?
Apprenticeship budget	● A table detailing each of the costs associated with employing the apprentice and who would be funding these in years 1, 2, 3 and 4 ● Salary Costs ○ What is the full annual salary for the apprentice, what is the hourly pay and how many hours per week will they be working ○ If you intend to pay an enhanced rate (higher than the national minimum wage for apprentices), how much would the VCF be contributing towards this increase annually and hourly. ● Equipment ○ What does the business want to provide in terms of equipment to help the apprentice ● Clothing ○ Are there PPE requirements for the job that you require funding for? ● Course fees (if not covered by another party) ○ Are there additional training courses you would like the apprentice to do where this isn't already covered by the current apprenticeship framework provision that would enhance their learning? ● Travel to college and overnight stays

	○ Are there additional costs being incurred by the employer whilst the apprentice attends college on the mainland? ● Your time invested (% of total working week) ○ How much one-on-one training time do you need to dedicate to the apprentice from your working week?
Supporting documents	● Your latest annual accounts ● Relevant insurance documents, i.e. employers liability insurance ● A copy of your child protection/vulnerable adults policy (if applicable) ● The details of a referee that can be contacted in support of your application if required.